Middle Section.—The first episode (bars 8, 9) is formed from the fragment of incidental counterpoint in the alto of bar 7. In bars 10 to 12 the impression of a stretto in the octave, at three crotchets' distance, is produced, but the bass really breaks away from the subject before the treble enters. After a second episode (bars 12, 13), consisting of a different treatment of the material of the first, a closer stretto is given to the two upper voices, the answer succeeding the subject at the distance of one crotchet; the bass supplies the countersubject (bars 15, 16). In bar 17 answer and subject are given by inverse movement, again at one crotchet's distance; and in bar 18 the subject in G minor, in its direct form, by bass and alto at the same distance of time. A third episode (bars 19 to 24) separates these from the final entries; the first part of this episode is derived from the codetta, the rest from the matter of the previous episodes.

Final Section.—The final section consists of only three bars and contains a stretto in the octave at half a bar's distance, for the two upper voices, with the countersubject in the bass from bar 26.

After the exposition, nearly all the entries of the subject and countersubject are more or less incomplete.

FUGUE 31 (Book II, 7)

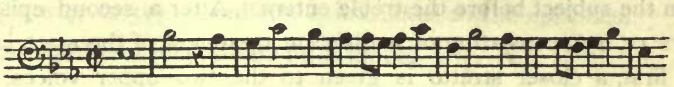
E FLAT MAJOR (FOUR VOICES).

A noteworthy feature of this fugue is the very small amount of modulation which it contains. Excepting at bar 53, where the key is A flat, the subject and answer are never introduced in any other keys than the tonic or dominant. It is, however, not

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 61-63.
BWV 876. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

difficult to divide into sections, the only peculiarity being in their relative proportions.

Exposition.—The subject is announced in the bass:—



The answer (tenor, bars 7 to 13) is **tonal,** both the dominant and the subdominant in bar 2 demanding the tonic to answer them. There is no regular countersubject, though a partial one, first heard from bar 9, second half, to bar 12, recurs in the exposition (bars 16 to 19, 23 to 26). After a few notes of codetta (bar 13) the alto and treble enter with subject and answer quite regularly, except that there is here another brief codetta (bar 20) which was not found in the first entries.

Counter-Exposition.—A counter-exposition commences at bar 30, the answer leading in the tenor; the bass follows with the subject, in stretto at one bar's distance, and in bars 37 to 43 the alto and treble give the same stretto inverted, with added counterpoints below.

Middle Section.—The first, and only episode is a rather long one (bars 44 to 53), mostly a canon at the fifth for treble and alto, with a counterpoint of free sequential pattern for the bass. It leads to the sole "middle entry" in bar 53—the subject in the subdominant key, with its first note altered and shortened.
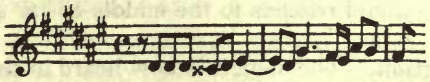
Final Section.—The return to the key of E flat follows immediately (bar 59), and the final entries again employ the stretto at a bar's distance, now given to the treble and bass. The added parts are similar to those in bars 37 to 44, but not actually in

quadruple counterpoint. The coda (bars 66 to 70) contains no feature of special note.

FUGUE 32 (Book II, 8)

D SHARP MINOR (FOUR VOICES).

Exposition.—The subject commences on the tonic and only touches the dominant quite incidentally:—



The answer, therefore, is **real.** The countersubject, begining at the middle of bar 3, is only used for the first half of the fugue, and is not found after 23. The order of entry of the voices is:—alto (subject), tenor (answer), bass (subject), tenor (answer). There is a codetta of two bars (bars 5 to 7, first quaver) between the tenor and bass entries; it is constructed of new material, and serves as the foundation for the two episodes. As in Fugue 29, the first of these (bars 11 to 15) does not modulate away from the original keys.

Middle Section.—The middle section proper, as a consequence, does not begin until bar 15, where the subject in the bass, by a slight alteration, is made to modulate into the subdominant key, G sharp minor; the countersubject is given to the treble. This entry is answered (bar 17) by the alto, similarly varied, but with countersubject absent, and passing into F sharp major, then (bar 19) by the tenor, with the countersubject (varied) in the bass, and passing into B, and finally (bar 21) by the treble in the original form and key, with the countersubject in the